

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/8: 1. Four relation models

RELIGION AND MORALITY

- +> DEPENDENCE: morality requires God/revelation
- +> INDEPENDENCE: moral truth is autonomous
- +> SUPPORT: morality is independent but religion motivates/sustains it
- +> TENSION: religious command or identity can conflict with moral judgement

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separate ontology (what makes right), epistemology (how known),
motivation (why act) and sanction (reward/punishment); one answer need not settle all four.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: 2. Divine command theory

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY

attractions: objective authority | categorical demand | accountability | motivation

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versions:

voluntarist: rightness constituted by command

epistemic: revelation tells us independently grounded moral truth

motivational: love/judgement strengthens compliance

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pressure: command identification, conflicting revelations, autonomy and arbitrariness.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: 3. Euthyphro and modified DCT

IS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?

+-> YES: morality appears arbitrary; cruelty could become right

+-> NO: goodness is independent; God is not its foundation

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MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

God's necessarily loving/good nature grounds value

divine commands flowing from that nature ground obligation

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reply blocks arbitrary commands; objection asks whether “good nature” is intelligible without a standard logically prior to command.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: 4. Kant and natural law

~~KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat~~

categorical imperative -> universal law + humanity as end

God and immortality are practical postulates of highest good, not sources of duty

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NATURAL LAW: practical reason reads goods and purposes in human nature;

Aquinas joins rational participation in eternal law with divine order

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contrast: obey because rationally right, not merely because commanded;

religion may complete moral hope without replacing moral deliberation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: 5. Indian moral grounding

MIKĀṢĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrva links ritual act and result

NYĀYA: God administers karma, but deserts arise from agents' acts

BUDDHISM: intention, compassion and non-harm within dependent origination; no creator

JAINISM: ahiṃsā and vows purify jīva by blocking karmic influx

GĪTĀ/VEDĀNTA: dharma, niṣkāma karma, devotion and knowledge reshape agency

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Indian ethics shows objective discipline without one uniform divine-command model.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: 6. Motivation and conduct

WHY BE MORAL?

fear of punishment -> hope of reward -> social belonging -> character/virtue
-> respect for persons -> compassion -> love of good/God

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lower motives may secure compliance but not moral maturity

religiosity can support self-control, service and forgiveness;

it can also rationalise bias when identity outruns universal concern

TEST: conduct and reasons, not ritual profession alone, reveal moral integration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: 7. Violence, Nietzsche and moral critique

RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

VIOLENCE PATH: exclusive truth + sacred authorisation + dehumanised out-group
+ political grievance -> moral disengagement

safeguards: interpretation, conscience, rights, plural institutions, non-violence

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NIETZSCHE: genealogy exposes resentment and life-denying slave morality

objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of weak

verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: 8. PYQ answer architecture

STATE precise dependence claim -> separate ground/knowledge/motive/sanction

-> DCT -> Euthyphro -> modified DCT -> Kant/natural law

-> Indian non-theistic and theistic models -> conduct/violence test -> verdict

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CLOSE: morality need not depend on divine command for intelligibility,

yet religion can deepen moral motivation, community and hope;

its legitimacy depends on whether faith remains answerable to reason, dignity and justice.